

Blasting Problems Hamper UTEP 9

Coach Andy Cohen's U.T. Miner nine might feel there should of been a blasting flag posted when it met Arizona University in both team's Western Athletic Conference opener at Dudley Field.

It was the blasting by Arizona catcher Dennis Haines that proved fatal to the Miners as they were dropped 9-4 in their WAC opener by the Wildcats.

HAINES LIT the fuse for three homers, all over the right field fence in leading the Cats over UTEP.

UTEP stayed in the game up through the sixth inning, but costly errors and five runs in the fifth, sixth and seventh

innings proved to be the downfall.

Both games well pitched and saw Arizona's starter Dave Breuker going the distance, allowing four runs on eight hits. UTEP's converted starter, Tim Peden was holding the Wildcat batters pretty well, but ran into problems in the late innings and was lifted in the eighth.

Barry Alburdis tried to spark a late rally with a two-run homer in the bottom of the eighth, but it fizzled out.

The Miners are now 10-20 overall and Arizona is 30-10.

ABA Playoff